Product Requirements Document for Context Sensitive Online Help

NOTE: *The content in this document was originally contained within Confluence. That information was exported to this Word document for reference purposes only.*

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Context Sensitive Online Help for [REDACTED] Tools

Feature Definition – What is Context Sensitive Online Help?

Problem*:*
We need to provide a quick and easy resource for users to get help and support on their own without relying on having to call the Help Desk.

Solution*:*
Online help is topic-based information delivered to digital tool users in electronic form: providing assistance or information about how and when to use an associated application, portal, or platform.

More specifically for the [REDACTED], context-sensitive help takes that ordinary online documentation one step further by providing an online help topic for each tool functionality/feature. This means that when the user clicks the online help icon/link/button, a help page directly corresponding to the page currently being displayed appears in a new window. See image below:

Users can search from any page within the online help. They are not limited to just the page that appears upon use of the help icon.

Value Proposition - Why do we need context sensitive online help?

The benefits and value of context sensitive online help include the following:

For Users:

- It provides help from **any place, any device, for anyone** logged into the tool.
- We can use **rich content** to provide readers with unambiguous guidelines (screen shots and other UI element images, diagrams, tables, etc.)
- **Easy navigation** using a variety of navigation elements (search box, table of contents, breadcrumbs, see also, next/previous topic, etc.).
- **Better customer experience** by providing a quick and easy way for the users to get help/assistance they need with the [REDACTED] features/functions; allowing them to get the most out of the platform, leading to better product adoption. This in turn supports long-term relationships between companies and clients.
- Centralized storage creating a quick **"one-stop shop"** for all the information a user needs to understand and utilize the application.

For [company name):

- Reduces the number of assistance requests to *[company name] Helpdesk.* Because users have help close at hand, ***there is less need to contact the Helpdesk:*** leading to ***lower product operations costs*** for [company name].
- Allows for ***better adoption and user experience***, thus gaining Client confidence in [company name]: potentially leading to ***increased earnings*** for [company name].

User Personas - Who uses online help?

All user personas actively logged into [REDACTED]. Personas include the following linked Jira work items:

P-001 [REDACTED]
P-002 [REDACTED]
P-003 [REDACTED]
P-004 [REDACTED]
P-005 [REDACTED]
P-006 [REDACTED]
P-007 [REDACTED]
P-008 [REDACTED]
P-009 [REDACTED]
P-010 [REDACTED]
P-011 [REDACTED]
P-012 [REDACTED]

Journey Stages - In what situations is online help used?

All scenarios.

Detailed Description

Tool, Format, and Output

- Madcap Flare is Tech Comm's tool of choice for [company name] documentation – more specifically, online help. Madcap Flare is being used to develop online help for the following reasons:
    - Allows **content reuse and single sourcing** (making maintenance faster and easier)
    - Can create **multiple targets** (which means creating different versions of help from one project)
    - **Topic-based authoring** (allowing for modular topics that can be used alone or grouped for flexibility)
    - Publishes to **multiple formats**
    - Provides **responsive layout** for any device (laptop, tablet, phone)
    - Many of the writers on the **Tech Comms team have experience** using Flare
- Online help for [REDACTED] will be context sensitive (for example, each screen within the [REDACTED] Portal has a corresponding help page that is called when the user clicks the help button/icon).
- Help files are published as a collection of HTML5 files.
- A help icon (or something similar) is added to the UI and appears at the top of the screen. When the user clicks this icon from any screen/window, the system calls the corresponding topic (using a specific URL) from the help project.

Implementation and Maintenance

- The help system is to be embedded as part of [REDACTED] itself. This requires a script added to the code that allows it to call the appropriate help page based on the screen (or URL) in the tool.
- The help will be configured to make calls as mapped by the writer within the online help system – between each screen within [REDACTED] and the corresponding help topic. This configuration is generally a one-time configuration and is not required for each sprint or PI.
  The Technical Writer is responsible for the online help system maintenance and updates.
- It is unknown at this time if each tool needs the script to launch help or if one central code change will allow the help to be accessed from any tool.
- Engineering assistance may be required for changes to how [REDACTED] is hosted.

Structure

- The entire help system is housed in a single folder and then subdivided within that into folders and topics
    - Each screen in the application has its own, assigned topic.
    - Each topic is able to stand on its own and not rely on other topics for

Design

The overall goal is to only give the user/reader as much information as they want to see. Additionally, we realize that users learn and comprehend information in different ways (that is, some do better with written instructions/context, and some need more visual information in the form of images). The current design allows for flexibility for how the information is presented to the user and eliminates the need for seemingly endless scrolling to find information.

- Planned layout and organization is as follows:
  - White space is to be used liberally, as it makes written documentation easier to read and comprehend.
  - A search field appears at the top of every topic, giving the user the ability to find information elsewhere in the help system, as needed.
  - Each topic will have an introductory paragraph.
- The intro paragraph will generally be followed by these sections:
  - "*Tell me about*" section – consisting of drop-down links that display various conceptual information when clicked. This section includes any field definitions – in table form, as well as any other diagrams or images that help the user understand the system.
  - "Tell me how to" section – consisting of drop-down links that display various procedural information when clicked. This section primarily exists of numbered step procedures along with screen captures that act as a visual guide.
  - "Also see" section – consisting of hyperlinks to other topics or areas of the help system that relate to the currently displayed topic.
  - A table of contents appears in the left side navigation pane.

Required Efforts from Engineering

The following outlines the plan for Engineering to get the help (as described above) integrated with all tools:

Links are provided as references.

- Information for integrating Flare with AWS: https://kb.madcapsoftware.com/Content/Misc/GEN1034Z_-_Publish_to_AWS_S3_Bucket_from_Flare.htm
- Beta version of [REDACTED] Online Help: https://[REDACTED]-docs-demo.internal.cloud.[company name].tech/Content/Home.htm
- First public release of the online help for FleetOps: [REDACTED LINK}

NOTE: *At this point in time, both the prototype and the Fleet Ops version of the help system has been published through AWS. We still need to work out how we integrate the help directly into the application so that it becomes a context-sensitive system.*

Assumptions

- Design of the online help (via proof of concept) has been reviewed and approved by the [REDACTED] UI team.
- Successful integration/implementation of the online help with the [REDACTED] portal.
- Tickets are created in Jira and assigned to the Technical Writer as each feature is ready for documentation (usually as it goes into testing). Links to the acceptance criteria for each completed feature must be included in the Jira ticket assigned to the writer.
- Technical Writer must have access to an environment that includes the new feature and that can be used to "play" with the different elements of the feature without interfering with data that already exists.
- The online help will be included in QA testing (method for this TBD).
- Updates to help topics or the help system once implemented can be published by the Technical Writer, as needed – without involvement of the Dev Team.

Planning and Scheduling

Planning and scheduling always follows that of feature work.

Summary

- By the time a pilot version is released to clients, we hope that we have the Help system published as HTML5 Context Sensitive help.
- Online help is for use by anyone logged into [REDACTED].
- Help is developed using the Help Authoring Tool, Madcap Flare, requiring minimal involvement of the engineering team and created/maintained/updated by the Technical Writer.
- The help system appears in its own browser window and piggybacks off the [REDACTED] AWS.
- When configured correctly, should result in greater efficiency for the writer when updating the help system, as well as for the implementation of release updates.
- The structure is based on an "as needed" basis and allows the user to control how much information they want to see.
- All assumptions must be correct for successful deployment of the online help.
- Planning and scheduling are based on feature release.

Platform Services Global Requirements

These are requirements that apply across the entire Customer Journey of this product component.

The key is ONHLP-xxx

ID	Title	Need	Why	Stakeholder	Source/VoC	Milestones	Refines	Priority	Change Date	Status
[REDACTED LINK}	Help System File	A help system (similar to a knowledge base) is created in HTML5 format for display from within each tool.	There needs to be a reliable way to create, maintain, and provide the help system.	TC/Kelley	Unembedded [REDACTED} version We want to find help when we need it. And it should be easy to find and access.		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Unembedded Help File Publishing	Until the help system is embedded in the platform, the help file must be published in such a way as to keep it secure from public access, but make it available to users. The help system is to be hosted outside of [REDACTED] via "piggybacking" off the [REDACTED] AWS environment – It is NOT embedded in [REDACTED] itself.	For safety and security, the help must be readily available to users but not the general public.	TC/Kelley	[REDACTED LINK}			TBD		Draft

ID	Title	Need	Why	Stakeholder	Source/VoC	Milestones	Refines	Priority	Change Date	Status
REDACTED LINK}	Responsive Help	The help system is responsive to screen size, depending upon device.	The way the help displays must accommodate the device on which it's being used (for example, help window should shrink horizontally when using a tablet, then expand for use on a laptop).	TC/Kelley	Responsive Content The way we see the help system should correspond to the device on which we are using it (such as tablet vs laptop vs phone).		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Provision of Page URLs	Url or other identifier needs to be provided for CSH mapping within the help authoring tool. The format of these URLs may be changing. Be sure the final format has been confirmed before using for mapping.	Context-sensitive help (CSH) only works when it's been mapped correctly. Therefore, there must be a way for the writer to identify the URLs (or page identifiers) so that they can be used to map to pages in the help system.	Developers	CSH-where the author provides a header file We want the help page that appears to directly correspond to the screen in the solution that is being displayed.			TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Help Icon Design	A help icon is designed to make it easy to find and call the help system.	There must be an easy, obvious way to see the icon.	UI/UX			[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Help Icon Implementation	An icon appears on the UI.	The icon allows the user to access the help system.	Developers	CSH-where author provides header file We want to find help when we need it. And it should be easy to find and access.		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft

ID	Title	Need	Why	Stakeholder	Source/VoC	Milestones	Refines	Priority	Change Date	Status
[REDACTED LINK}	Implement Context Sensitivity Script	Coding has been added to each tool that allows it to call the correct page in the help system.	Code must be added into the solution that tells each screen where to find the help, so that the corresponding help page can be displayed when the help icon is clicked (for example, when the map is displayed and a user clicks on the help icon, the help page that appears relates specifically to map functionality and features).	Developers The effort level for developers on this task is a "1".	CSH-where the author provides a header file We want the help page that appears to directly correspond to the screen in the solution that is being displayed.		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Provision of Page URLs	Url or other identifier needs to be provided for CSH mapping within the help authoring tool. The format of these URLs may be changing. Be sure the final format has been confirmed before using it for mapping.	Context-sensitive help (CSH) only works when it's been mapped correctly. Therefore, there must be a way for the writer to identify the URLs (or page identifiers) so that they can be used to map to pages in the help system.	Developers	CSH-where the author provides a header file We want the help page that appears to directly correspond to the screen in the solution that is being displayed.			TBD		Draft

ID	Title	Need	Why	Stakeholder	Source/VoC	Milestones	Refines	Priority	Change Date	Status
[REDACTED LINK}	Context Sensitive Mapping	Each screen in the solution is mapped to a corresponding page within the online help.	Mapping within the help system associates a screen in the solution with a page in the online help - this is what is known as context-sensitive help (CSH).	TC/Kelley	Supported Outputs We want the help page that appears to directly correspond to the screen in the solution that is being displayed.		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft
[REDACTED LINK}	Help Maintenance	The help system is updated each time a function or feature is added, changed, or removed.	The help system has to be maintained so that it accurately represents and corresponds with what is happening in the solution.	TC/Kelley	We want to find help when we need it. And it should be easy to find and access.		[REDACTED LINK}	TBD		Draft